Harland & Price LLP

Solicitors
9 Cathedral Walk
Northam NM1 1RP
Ref: HP/CN/2291/RT

Dr A Expert
Expert Witness (General Practice)
By secure email

9 October 2025

Dear Dr Expert

Margaret Ashworth v Brookvale Surgery (Dr R Patel and Dr S Okafor)
Letter of instruction - breach of duty, general practice

1. We act for the Claimant, Mrs Margaret Ashworth (date of birth 14/03/1969), in a claim against the general practitioners at Brookvale Surgery. Mrs Ashworth was diagnosed with adenocarcinoma of the sigmoid colon in September 2024. She alleges that the diagnosis was delayed.

2. We enclose the paginated medical records (450 pages), the Claimant's witness statement and a copy of Part 35 and Practice Direction 35. Please confirm you have no conflict of interest before reading the records.

3. Your report should comply with Part 35 and should be addressed to the court. We should be grateful for your report within 8 weeks. Please tell us immediately if you need further records.

4. Questions. Please answer the following questions:

   (a) Please set out your view of the standard of care provided by the general practitioners between February and August 2024.

   (b) In particular, did the standard of care provided at the consultation on 15 May 2024 fall below that of a reasonably competent general practitioner, and if so in what respects?

   (c) Would a reasonably competent general practitioner have referred Mrs Ashworth on the urgent suspected cancer pathway, and if so by what date?

   (d) If Mrs Ashworth had been referred earlier, on the balance of probabilities would her cancer have been diagnosed at an earlier stage?

5. Assumptions. You should assume that Mrs Ashworth's account of her symptoms in her witness statement is accurate unless the records clearly show otherwise.

6. We understand question (d) concerns causation and may fall outside your expertise. If so, please say so and we will instruct a colorectal surgeon.

Yours sincerely

R. Tennant, Partner, Harland & Price LLP

Synthetic test record - invented patient - not real clinical data